



COMMUNICATIONS MANAGEMENT PLAN TEMPLATE

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COMMUNICATION MANAGEMENT PLAN DOST STARBOOKS: WHIZ CHALLENGE

**DOST Science and Technology Information Institute
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INTRODUCTION

This Communications Management Plan sets out the communications framework for the DOST STARBOOKS Whiz Challenge. It will serve as a guide for communications throughout the life of the project and will be updated as communication needs change. This plan identifies and defines the roles of people involved in this project. It also includes a communications matrix which maps the communication requirements of this project. An in-depth guide for conducting meetings details both the communications rules and how the meetings will be conducted, ensuring successful meetings. A project team directory is included to provide contact information for all stakeholders directly involved in the project.

COMMUNICATIONS MANAGEMENT APPROACH

The Project Manager will take a proactive role in ensuring effective communications on this project. The communications requirements are documented in the Communications Matrix presented in this document. The Communications Matrix will be used as the guide for what information to communicate, who is to communicate, when to communicate it, and to whom to communicate.

As the project progresses, updates or changes to the communication plan may be required due to changes in personnel, scope, or stakeholder needs. The Project Manager is responsible for managing all proposed and approved changes to the communications management plan. Once changes are approved, updates will be distributed to all stakeholders.

This methodology aligns with the project's change management approach and ensures that all stakeholders, including representatives from the Department of Science and Technology – Science and Technology Information Institute (DOST-STII), remain informed throughout the project lifecycle.

COMMUNICATIONS MANAGEMENT CONSTRAINTS

All project communication activities will occur within the approved budget, schedule, and resource allocations. The Project Manager is responsible for ensuring that communication activities do not exceed allocated resources.

Communication activities will follow the frequencies defined in the Communication Matrix. Any deviation must be approved by DOST-STII.

Organizational policies require that standardized templates and formats be used for all formal communications. Additionally, only authorized personnel from DOST-STII may approve the release of sensitive or confidential information. The Project Manager must ensure proper authorization is obtained prior to distribution.



STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION REQUIREMENTS

The project includes a diverse group of stakeholders such as DOST-STII representatives, school administrators, educators, students, and the project team. The Project Manager will coordinate with stakeholders to determine their preferred communication methods and frequency.

Stakeholder communication preferences will be documented and maintained in the Stakeholder Register. Standard communication will follow the Communication Matrix, but additional communication may be conducted as needed.

All stakeholders will be provided access to communication platforms used in the project. Secure communication channels will be used when necessary to ensure data confidentiality.

ROLES

Project Sponsor

The Project Sponsor is the Department of Science and Technology – Science and Technology Information Institute (DOST-STII). The Project Sponsor is the champion of the project and has authorized it through approval of the project charter. This role is responsible for funding the project and is ultimately accountable for its success. Communications with the Project Sponsor will be presented in summary format unless more detailed information is requested.

Program Manager

The Program Manager oversees the project at a higher organizational level and ensures alignment with STARBOOKS initiatives and strategic objectives. The Program Manager is responsible for monitoring overall progress, resource utilization, and ensuring that the project contributes to the goals of the STARBOOKS program. This role requires more detailed communication than the Project Sponsor.

Key Stakeholders

Key Stakeholders include DOST-STII representatives, STARBOOKS administrators, school administrators, and educators who have a direct interest in the project. These stakeholders may influence project decisions and are actively involved in providing feedback, reviewing deliverables, and ensuring successful implementation. Regular communication and engagement are required to manage expectations and ensure alignment.

Change Control Board

The Change Control Board (CCB) is responsible for reviewing and approving any changes to the project scope, schedule, or system features. It includes representatives from DOST-STII, the



Project Manager, and the Technical Lead. The CCB ensures that all changes are properly evaluated, documented, and aligned with project objectives.

Customer

The customer for this project is Department of Science and Technology – Science and Technology Information Institute (DOST-STII). As the customer who will be accepting the final deliverable of this project they will be informed of the project status including potential impacts to the schedule for the final deliverable or the product itself.

Project Manager

The Project Manager has overall responsibility for the execution of the project. The Project Manager manages day to day resources, provides project guidance and monitors and reports on the projects metrics as defined in the Project Management Plan. As the person responsible for the execution of the project, the Project Manager is the primary communicator for the project distributing information according to this Communications Management Plan.

Project Team

The Project Team is comprised of all persons who have a role performing work on the project. The project team needs to have a clear understanding of the work to be completed and the framework in which the project is to be executed. Since the Project Team is responsible for completing the work for the project they played a key role in creating the Project Plan including defining its schedule and work packages. The Project Team requires a detailed level of communications which is achieved through day to day interactions with the Project Manager and other team members along with weekly team meetings.

Steering Committee

The Steering Committee includes management representing the departments which make up the organization. The Steering Committee provides strategic oversight for changes which impact the overall organization. The purpose of the Steering Committee is to ensure that changes within the organization are effected in such a way that it benefits the organization as a whole. The Steering Committee requires communication on matters which will change the scope of the project and its deliverables.

Technical Lead

The Technical Lead is a person on the Project Team who is designated to be responsible for ensuring that all technical aspects of the project are addressed and that the project is implemented in a technically sound manner. The Technical Lead is responsible for all technical designs, overseeing the implementation of the designs and developing as-build documentation. The Technical Lead requires close communications with the Project Manager and the Project Team.



PROJECT TEAM DIRECTORY

The following table presents contact information for all persons identified in this communications management plan. The email addresses and phone numbers in this table will be used to communicate with these people.

Role	Name	Title	Organization/ Department	Email
Project Sponsor	Marievic V. Narquita	Head of DOST-STII	Information Services Section (ISS)	mavie.narquita@stii.dost.gov.ph
Project Manager	Kelly Dumbrique	Project Manager	NEXUS	ksdumbrique2@student.apc.edu.ph
Technical Lead	Arcielle Marie Gercan	Technical Lead	NEXUS	acgercan@student.apc.edu.ph
Backend Developer	Arcielle Marie Gercan	Backend Developer	NEXUS	acgercan@student.apc.edu.ph
Frontend Developers	Shandrae Lois Quianzon Kelly Dumbrique Janice Maxene Salipande	Frontend Developer	NEXUS	saquianzon@student.apc.edu.ph ksdumbrique2@student.apc.edu.ph Jdsalipande2@student.apc.edu.ph
UI/UX Designers	Janice Maxene Salipande Shandrae Lois Quianzon	UI/UX Designers	NEXUS	Jdsalipande2@student.apc.edu.ph saquianzon@student.apc.edu.ph
QA/Test Lead	Janice Maxene Salipande	Project Manager	NEXUS	Jdsalipande2@student.apc.edu.ph



Documentation Lead	Janice Maxene Salipande	Documentation Lead	NEXUS	Jdsalipande2@student.apc.edu.ph
Key Stakeholders	See Stakeholder Register	Various Roles	Schools / Educators / Admins	See Stakeholder Register
Customer	DOST-STII	Management	Department of Science and Technology – Science and Technology Information Institute (DOST-STII)	dost@dost.gov.ph

COMMUNICATION METHODS AND TECHNOLOGIES

The project team will determine, in accordance with Department of Science and Technology – Science and Technology Information Institute (DOST-STII) organizational policy, the communication methods and technologies based on several factors to include: stakeholder communication requirements, available technologies (internal and external), and organizational policies and standards.

DOST-STII maintains a SharePoint platform within the PMO which all projects use to provide updates, archive various reports, and conduct project communications. This platform enables senior management, as well as stakeholders with compatible technology, to access project data and communications at any point in time. SharePoint also provides the ability for stakeholders and project team members to collaborate on project work and communication.

For stakeholders who do not have the ability to access SharePoint, a web site will also be established for the project. Access to the website will be controlled with a username and password. Any stakeholders identified who are not able to access SharePoint will be issued a unique username and password in order to access the web site. The project manager is responsible for ensuring all project communications and documentation are copied to the web site and that the content mirrors what is contained on the SharePoint platform.

DOST-STII maintains software licenses for MS Project software. All project teams are responsible for developing, maintaining, and communicating schedules using this software. PERT Charts are the preferred format for communicating schedules to stakeholders. The project schedule will be maintained on both the SharePoint platform and the project website.



All project communication and documentation, in addition to being maintained on the SharePoint platform and project website, will be archived on the internal DOST-STII shared drive which resides in the PMO program directory. Organizational naming conventions for files and folder will be applied to all archived work.





COMMUNICATIONS MATRIX

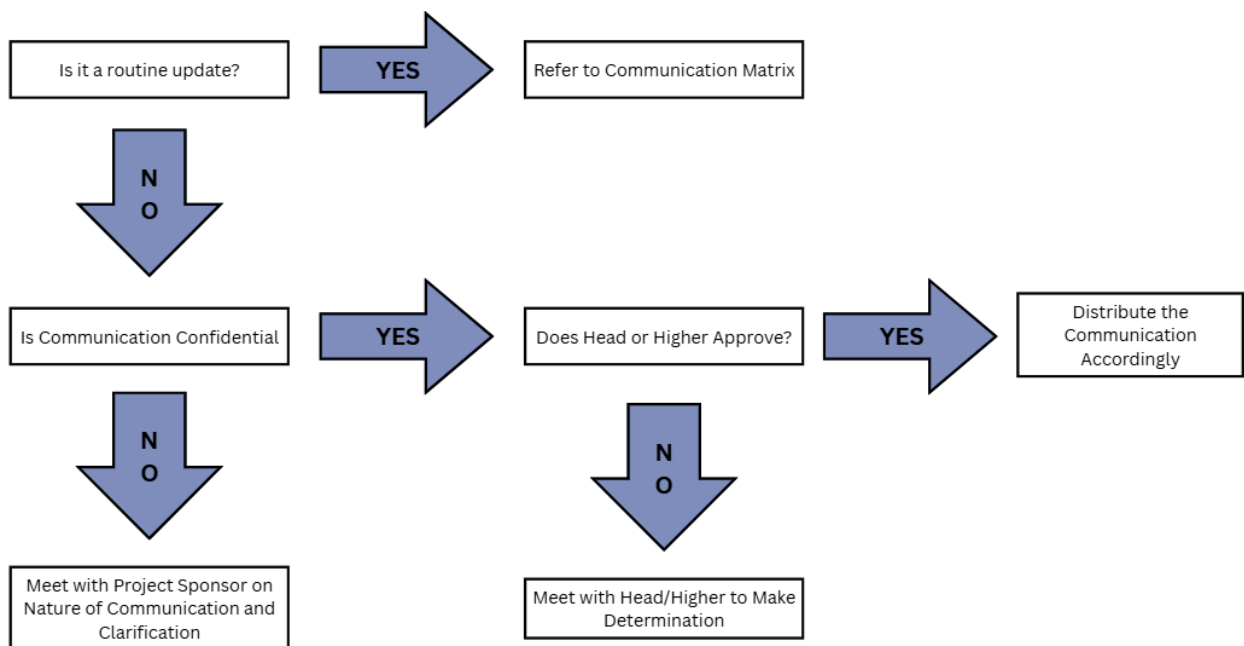
The following table identifies the communications requirements for this project.

Communication Type	Objective of Communication	Medium	Frequency	Audience	Owner	Deliverable	Format
Kickoff Meeting	Introduce the project team and the project. Review project objectives and management approach.	• Face to Face	Once	• Project Sponsor • Project Team • Stakeholders	Project Manager	• Agenda • Meeting Minutes	• Soft copy archived on project SharePoint site and project web site
Project Team Meetings	Review status of the project with the team.	• Face to Face • Conference Call	Weekly	• Project Team	Project Manager	• Agenda • Meeting Minutes • Project schedule	• Soft copy archived on project SharePoint site and project web site
Technical Design Meetings	Discuss and develop technical design solutions for the project.	• Face to Face	As Needed	• Project Technical Staff	Technical Lead	• Agenda • Meeting Minutes	• Soft copy archived on project SharePoint site and project web site
Monthly Project Status Meetings	Report on the status of the project to management.	• Face to Face • Conference Call	Monthly	• PMO	Project Manager	• Slide updates • Project schedule	• Soft copy archived on project SharePoint site and project web site
Project Status Reports	Report the status of the project including activities, progress, costs and issues.	• Email	Monthly	• Project Sponsor • Project Team • Stakeholders • PMO	Project Manager	• Project Status Report • Project schedule	• Soft copy archived on project SharePoint site and project web site



COMMUNICATION FLOWCHART

The communication flowchart below was created to aid in project communication. This flowchart provides a framework for the project team to follow for this project. However, there may be occasions or situations which fall outside of the communication flowchart where additional clarification is necessary. In these situations the Project Manager is responsible for discussing the communication with the Project Sponsor and making a determination on how to proceed.



GUIDELINES FOR MEETINGS

All project meetings, including sprint reviews, team standups, technical design sessions, and stakeholder meetings, will be documented using Group NEXUS's standardized Minutes of the Meeting (MOTM) template. The MOTM serves as the official record for all project meetings and must be completed for every session, regardless of format or duration.



Meeting Documentation

Each MOTM record captures the following:

- **Activity Details** — Control number, meeting date, venue or platform, time start and end, and video recording link where applicable
- **Attendees** — Screenshots of the start and end of the meeting, the Meeting Facilitator, Secretary, and a complete list of attendees
- **Agenda** — Itemized discussion topics with corresponding key discussions, decisions made, and next steps for each item
- **Action Items** — A log of all tasks arising from the meeting, with the assigned person responsible and the due date for each item

Meeting Agenda

The Meeting Facilitator is responsible for preparing and distributing the meeting agenda prior to each session. The agenda must identify all discussion items to be covered and should be shared with all attendees in advance to allow adequate preparation.

Meeting Facilitation

The Meeting Facilitator is responsible for opening the meeting, guiding discussion through all agenda items, ensuring the meeting starts and ends on time, and capturing the required start and end screenshots for the MOTM record.

Secretary / Note Taker

The designated Secretary is responsible for documenting key discussions, decisions made, and next steps for each agenda item during the meeting. The Secretary is also responsible for logging all action items, including the person responsible and the due date. The completed MOTM must be finalized and distributed to all attendees within 2 business days following the meeting.

Action Items

Action items are formally recorded in the Action Items section of the MOTM. Each item must have a clearly identified owner and a defined due date. Open action items from previous meetings will be reviewed at the start of the immediately following session to confirm resolution status before proceeding to the current agenda.



Meeting Records and Archiving

All completed MOTM documents will be archived on the DOST-STII SharePoint platform and the project website following distribution. Control numbers must follow the NEXUS-MOTM[XX] format to ensure traceability across the project lifecycle. Video recording links, where available, must be included in the MOTM record prior to archiving.

Parking Lot

Items raised during a meeting that fall outside the current agenda but merit follow-up will be deferred to the Parking Lot. The Secretary will log these items, and the Meeting Facilitator will assign an owner responsible for ensuring appropriate follow-up — either in a future meeting or through another communication channel. Parking Lot items will be included in the distributed MOTM.

COMMUNICATION STANDARDS

For this project, DOST-STII. will utilize standard organizational formats and templates for all formal project communications. Formal project communications are detailed in the project's communication matrix and include:

Kickoff Meeting – project team will utilize DOST-STII standard templates for meeting agenda and meeting minutes. Additionally, any slides presented will use the DOST-STII standard slideshow template.

Project Team Meetings – project team will utilize DOST-STII standard templates for meeting agenda and meeting minutes. Additionally, any slides presented will use the DOST-STII standard slideshow template.

Technical Design Meetings - project team will utilize DOST-STII standard templates for meeting agenda and meeting minutes. Additionally, any slides presented will use the DOST-STII standard slideshow template.

Monthly Project Status Meetings - project team will utilize DOST-STII standard templates for meeting agenda and meeting minutes. Additionally, any slides presented will use the DOST-STII standard slideshow template.

Project Status Reports – project team will utilize DOST-STII standard templates for meeting agenda and meeting minutes. Additionally the standard project status report document, available on the share drive, will be used to provide project status.



Informal project communications should be professional and effective but there is no standard template or format that must be used.

COMMUNICATION ESCALATION PROCESS

Efficient and timely communication is the key to successful project completion. As such, it is imperative that any disputes, conflicts, or discrepancies regarding project communications are resolved in a way that is conducive to maintaining the project schedule, ensuring the correct communications are distributed, and preventing any ongoing difficulties. In order to ensure projects stay on schedule and issues are resolved, ABC Corp. will use its standard escalation model to provide a framework for escalating communication issues. The table below defines the priority levels, decision authorities, and timeframes for resolution.

Priority	Definition	Decision Authority	Timeframe for Resolution
Priority 1	Major impact to project or business operations. If not resolved quickly there will be a significant adverse impact to revenue and/or schedule.	DOST-STII Management	Within 4 hours
Priority 2	Medium impact to project or business operations which may result in some adverse impact to revenue and/or schedule.	Project Sponsor	Within one business day
Priority 3	Slight impact which may cause some minor scheduling difficulties with the project but no impact to business operations or revenue.	Project Manager	Within two business days
Priority 4	Insignificant impact to project but there may be a better solution.	Project Manager	Work continues and any recommendations are submitted via the project change control process

**** NOTE:** Any communication including sensitive and/or confidential information will require approval from DOST-STII for approval prior to external distribution.

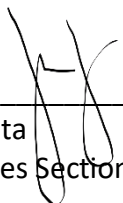


GLOSSARY OF COMMUNICATION TERMINOLOGY

Term	Definition
Communication	The effective sending and receiving of information. Ideally, the information received should match the information sent. It is the responsibility of the sender to ensure this takes place.
Stakeholder	Individuals or groups involved in the project or whose interests may be affected by the project's execution or outcome.
Communications Management Plan	Portion of the overall Project Management Plan which details how project communications will be conducted, who will participate in communications, frequency of communications, and methods of communications.
Escalation	The process which details how conflicts and issues will be passed up the management chain for resolution as well as the timeframe to achieve resolution.

SPONSOR ACCEPTANCE

Approved by the Project Sponsor:



Marievic V. Narquita
Information Services Section (ISS) Head of DOST-STII

Date: April 8, 2026

